

Superstore Profitability Analysis

Business Analysis Portfolio Project · Sales & Profitability Analysis

Business Question

Company-wide profit has been inconsistent despite steady sales growth. This analysis would be in product lines across regions.

Key Finding

Tables is the only sub-category losing money company-wide and the loss is not driven by discounting. Average discount on Tables is consistent across all four regions, yet three of the four regions (East, Central, South) post negative profit on this product, while the West region remains profitable.

Supporting Detail

- Tables is the single sub-category with negative overall profit across the dataset.
- West is the only region where Tables is profitable; East, Central, and South all post losses on this sub-category.
- Average discount on Tables is similar across all four regions — ruling out discounting as the driver of the regional gap.
- Because pricing behavior doesn't explain the difference, the more likely drivers are structural: cost-to-serve (freight/shipping cost per order), supplier or fulfillment cost differences by region, or product mix within the Tables sub-category varying by region.

Recommendations

1. Investigate cost-to-serve for Tables outside the West region — specifically freight cost per order and supplier/unit cost — since pricing and discounting are ruled out as causes.
2. Do not adjust discounting as a first step — since discount levels are already consistent across regions, changing them is unlikely to fix the gap. Run the cost audit first.
3. Benchmark West's fulfillment setup for Tables (carrier, warehouse, supplier) against the other three regions to identify what West is doing differently.
4. Re-evaluate whether Tables should be carried at current price points in the three underperforming regions if cost structure cannot be improved.

Methodology & Tools

Data was cleaned and explored in Excel (duplicate removal, date formatting, calculated Profit Margin and Ship Delay fields, PivotTable analysis by category, sub-category, region, and discount). Findings were visualized in an interactive Tableau Public dashboard covering sales/profit trend, profit by sub-category, discount-vs-profit relationship, and regional performance, with a region filter for interactivity.

Dashboard: [Link](#)